

Smart India Hackathon - Evaluation Matrix

This document outlines the standard evaluation matrix and criteria used by the SIH CodeJudge Service to assess student submissions. The evaluation is scored out of a maximum of 100 points, broken down into Primary Criteria (50%), Technical Quality (35%), and Ancillary Criteria (15%).

1. Primary Criteria (50% of Score)

- Problem Statement Alignment (25 Points): Requirement matching and explicit evidence that the submitted project satisfies the exact constraints of the chosen problem statement.
- Functional Implementation (25 Points): Build and run evidence, along with functional/API testing proving that the core system is actually working.

2. Technical Quality (35% of Score)

- Engineering / Code Quality (15 Points): Clean codebase standards, proper entry points, bootstrap mechanisms, and agentic-legibility.
- Architecture (10 Points): Modularity, appropriate layering, structured project directories, and clear separation of concerns.
- Testing (10 Points): Presence of a test suite, valid test configurations, and active validation signals.

3. Ancillary Criteria (15% of Score)

- Innovation (5 Points): The quality of the idea/approach (advisory/human-curable).
- Security (5 Points): Proper .gitignore setup, dependency-update hygiene, and lack of exposed secrets/SAST findings.
- Documentation (5 Points): Presence of a comprehensive README.md, setup instructions, API docs, and contributing guides.

Automated Penalty Policies

- Critical Security Finding: Any critical finding (e.g., exposed AWS keys) immediately blocks the evaluation and flags it as BLOCKED.
- High Security Penalty: Every HIGH security finding deducts 3 points from the Security category.
- Passing Threshold: A minimum automated score of 40 points is expected for passing (subject to manual evaluator decision).